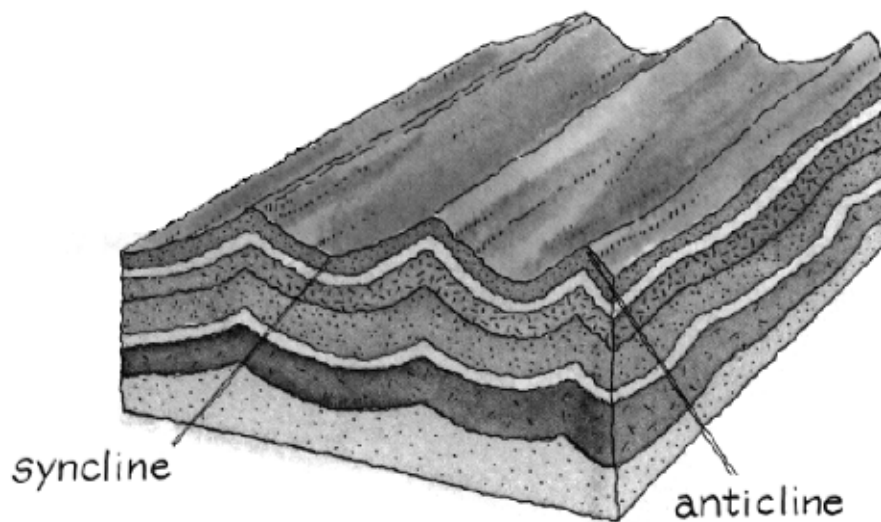


## FOLDS AND FAULTS

Most of the world's mountain ranges are made up of sedimentary rock which formed mainly under water. How did they form such large structures? Obviously large forces are at work.

Rock that is put under great pressure and heat will soften and become "plastic", bending into curves that lift part of the rock up to form mountains.

Geologists call an upfold an **anticline** and a fold like a trough is a **syncline**.



Sometimes rocks under pressure crack. The pressure can cause rocks to move along the crack, either vertically or horizontally.

The crack is called a **fault** and can be formed by squeezing or stretching the Earth's crust.

The movement along a fault can range from a few centimetres to thousands of metres.

A **fault-block mountain** occurs when the movement on one side of a fault is huge compared to the other.

If the movement along a fault is rapid, an earthquake may occur.

